

running on 36 per cent renewable energy and will be 100 per cent renewable by 2030. Leela already has two LEED Platinum-certified hotels and plans to have all the hotels certified by mid-2023.

THE OBEROI GROUP, too, is focussing on renewable energy with several of its hotels utilising power from only renewable sources. For instance, The Wildflower Hall and The Oberoi Cecil, Shimla, procure 100 per cent of their power requirements from local hydroelectric power stations, while The Oberoi Bengaluru and Trident Chennai get it from wind power sources. Likewise, The Oberoi Gurugram and Trident Gurugram source 100 per cent of their power requirements from off-site solar power plants. Even luxury properties such as The Oberoi Udaivilas and The Oberoi Vanyavilas source up to 50 per cent of their power requirements from recently commissioned solar plants within the hotels' premises. Several hotels have efficient systems for the management of water resources and quite a few have installed rainwater harvesting systems and STPs.

Technology, too, plays an important role. At Leela, for instance, sustainability goals are on the general manager's (GM) scorecard. "We work with Schneider on an app-based tool called Resource Advisor that helps us track our decarbonisation efforts. So, each GM knows how his/her hotel is doing," says Bhatnagar. Similarly, Indian Hotels Company (IHCL), better known as the Taj



(From left) Taj Exotica Resort and Spa, Andamans. Under its ESG project, Paathya hotel chain completely sustainable by 2030; Six Senses Fort Barwara has stopped housekeeping usage



"We decided to take the road less travelled and bring luxury and sustainability together in a way that the guest experiences luxury and contributes to a planet-positive world"

Anil Chadha
DIVISIONAL CHIEF
EXECUTIVE, ITC HOTELS

group—India's largest hospitality company with a portfolio of 242 hotels including 62 under development—has a strategic collaboration with IFC TechEmerge, where new technologies funded by IFC are being piloted across its hotels. "These new technologies are helping us increase efficiencies, which in turn will reduce costs. Some of these are IoT-based and can be easily replicated across our hotels," says Gaurav Pokhariyal, Executive Vice President (Human Resources), IHCL.

IHCL had earlier this year introduced its ESG project, Paathya, as part of which it set a number of short- and long-term sustainability goals with the intention of making the hotel chain completely sustain-